John A. Logan College
Online Course Assessment Rubric

Online Course Assessment

COURSE BEING ACCESSED		ATTENDEE ROLES	ATTENDEE	ADDITIONAL ATTENDEE ROLES	ADDITIONAL ATTENDEE
Instructor		Facilitator			
Date		Faculty Representative			
Course ID		Faculty Representative			
Course Title		TLC Representative			
# of In Person Meets		Admin Representative			

Additional Online/Hybrid/HyFlex Courses Taught

ADDITIONAL COURSES ID	TITLE	# OF IN PERSON MEETS	ACTIVE	NOT ACTIVE (LAST SEMESTER TAUGHT)	NOTES

☐ *Verbal confirmation: Instructor acknowledges that even though the committee may only require one of their courses to be presented during the assessment, the course assessment rubric items should be applied to all online, hybrid, and hyflex courses.*

Section 1 - Required Course Site Elements

The following items are required of all online courses. Indicate if the required element is identified in the online course by marking:

NA = NOT APPLICABLE	X = NOT PRESENT	0 = NOT PRESENT IN ALL COURSE/DEVELOPING	1 = PRESENT/ACCOMPLISHED

ITEMS	IDENTIFIED	NOTES
Course Syllabus Information		
Course syllabus is available		
Course objectives are stated		
All required learning materials, including technology tools.		
Textbook Information: author, title, edition, publisher, ISBN		
Tentative Course Schedule		
Course Information Provided in Course		
How to get started directions		
Welcome Message (announcement and/or course information, etc.)		
Course provides guidance on how to navigate the course.		
Course Pacing and Structure		
Course includes step-by-step guides or tutorials for all required technologies.		
Netiquette posted or students directed "Netiquette" link and additional guidelines for student interactions.		
Policy/Procedure/Statements specific to your course (what to expect from this course) Examples: consisted due dates, late policy, communication preference, grading/feedback timelines, AI guidelines, etc.		
Course provides support resources. Example: Course content questions, course software, IT, D2L, etc.		
Students informed how to request accommodations.		
Contact info for Disability Services provided.		
Staff Information / Profile within the Course		
Name		
Email		
Work Phone (includes telephone number and extension number)		
Response time stated		
Office Location		
Office Hours		
Degrees		
Verbal Confirmation		
Verbal confirmation from instructor that all necessary copyright clearance has been obtained for all material used in course (graphics, videos, etc.)		

SECTION 1 NOTES

Section 2 – Learner Readiness

Careful learner self-assessment and reflection on student learning styles/preferences, technological skills, and possible special needs are essential to successful student learning outcomes. Tools should be provided to reinforce student self-analysis of abilities, knowledge, and skills necessary for successful completion of the online class. Information should be provided to address challenges discovered in the self-assessments.

Indicate if the required element is identified in the online course by marking:

NA = NOT APPLICABLE	0 = NOT PRESENT	0 = NOT PRESENT IN ALL COURSE/DEVELOPING	1 = PRESENT/ACCOMPLISHED

ITEMS	IDENTIFIED	NOTES
Course Specific		
Course Specific Technology Preparedness Example: Integrity Advocate, Software, Online Tools		
JALC Learner		
D2L Online Orientation Course This course includes the additional assessment resources below		
Additional Student Self-Assessment Resources		
Technology skills are compatible with online learning		
Learning styles are compatible with online learning		
Access to technology is compatible with online learning		
Other		

SECTION 2 NOTES

Section 3 – Course Structure

Clear learning objectives throughout provide a useful framework for the courses' content, activities, and learning assessments. Construction units or modules around discrete objectives help structure students' learning, making the course more unified and coherent.

Indicate if the required element is identified in the online course by marking:

NA = NOT APPLICABLE	X = NOT PRESENT	0 = NOT PRESENT IN ALL COURSE/DEVELOPING	1 = PRESENT/ACCOMPLISHED

ITEMS	IDENTIFIED	NOTES
Structure of course is clearly identified (i.e. module based, unit based, weekly based, chapter/lesson based)		
Course objectives are provided for each unit of study		
Overview provided for each unit of study (summary, checklist, etc.)		
All required course materials/assessments should be present in the appropriate unit of study (module, weeks).		
Course materials are free of broken links, spelling errors, and incorrect information.		
All modules, assignments, and activities include clear and detailed instructions (guidelines, timelines, etc.)		
A specific due date for each learning activity is provided		
Course site navigation is intuitive and consistent.		

SECTION 3 NOTES

Section 4 – Active Learning Design

Engaging students in application activities encourages active learning and continual involvement with course content.

Indicate if the required element is identified in the online course by marking:

NA = NOT APPLICABLE	X = NOT PRESENT	0 = NOT PRESENT IN ALL COURSE/DEVELOPING	1 = PRESENT/ACCOMPLISHED

ITEMS	IDENTIFIED	NOTES
Online Discussion		
Role Playing		
Problem Solving		
Writing (Reflective, Analytical, etc.)		
Group work		
Case Study		
Peer Review		
Interactive Media (Virtual Tours, Online Gaming, etc.)		
Other activity:		
Other activity:		
Totals (base is 10)		
Advanced (80% of applicable items above incorporated)		
Essential (40 – 70% of applicable items above incorporated)		
Being Developed (10 – 30% of applicable items above incorporated)		
Not Evident		

SECTION 4 NOTES

Section 5 – Learning Assessment

Frequent learning assessments–either Graded or Ungraded—can help students evaluate and guide their own learning and can help instructors adjust to learners' needs throughout the course. Evaluation criteria or rubrics should be identified for all assessment methods. Tying assessments closely to objectives adds further consistency and clarity to the course.

Indicate if the required element is identified in the online course by marking:

NA = NOT APPLICABLE	X = NOT PRESENT	0 = NOT PRESENT IN ALL COURSE/DEVELOPING	1 = PRESENT/ACCOMPLISHED

ITEMS (items other than quizzes/exams & discussions can count as more than one)	IDENTIFIED	COURSE OBJECTIVE(S)	RUBRIC	NOTES
Quiz / Exam				
Online discussion				
Student Self-Assessment (Survey, Practices, Practice Test, etc) Process by which the student gathers information about and reflects on his or her own learning				
Review (peer, literature, website)				
Case Study				
Project				
Paper (research based, creative, etc.)				
Multimedia presentation (PowerPoint, video, etc.)				
Other learning assessment _____				
Other learning assessment _____				
Can count as more than one				
Totals (base is 10)				
Advanced (80% of applicable items above incorporated)				
Essential (40 – 70% of applicable items above incorporated)				
Being Developed (10 – 30% of applicable items above incorporated)				
Not Evident				

SECTION 5 NOTES

Section 6 – Communication/Course Delivery

Regular and Substantive Interaction (RSI) is important because it's at the core of what makes an online course truly instructional rather than just a correspondence course. The U.S. Department of Education requires that all online courses ensure that there is regular and substantive interaction between students and faculty.

"Regular" means predictable & consistent: interactions should happen frequently (weekly/per module) and on a schedule students can expect.

"Substantive" means academic, meaningful, two of the categories: direct instruction; assessment/feedback; responding to content questions; facilitating discussion; or other approved instructional work.

Instructor initiation is required: interactions can't all be reactive. The instructor must proactively engage.

Indicate if the required element is identified in the online course by marking:

NA = NOT APPLICABLE	X = NOT PRESENT	0 = NOT PRESENT IN ALL COURSES/DEVELOPING	1 = PRESENT/ACCOMPLISHED

ITEMS	EXAMPLE(S)	IDENTIFIED	NOTES
Regular Interaction	*Predictable, consistent and initiated*	*(at least 1 instructor-initiated communication per week)*	
Weekly Contact	Send announcements that do more than logistics — i.e. tie into course content, highlight challenges, preview upcoming work. Check-in messages		
Monitor Student Progress Ongoing	Monitor student activity (logins, assignments, participation) and provide personalized outreach to inactive or at-risk students and/or feedback follow-ups		
Instructor Availability Listed & Predictable	Hold virtual or in-person office hours, chats, "Ask the Instructor" forum, Q&A session on a predictable schedule.		
Substantiative Interaction	*Academic, content-based, and meaningful*	*(at least two types regularly (each module/week)*	
Providing direct instruction	Live synchronous online interactions where instructor and learners are present online at the same time. Online mini lessons, review sessions, tutorials,		
Assessing or providing feedback on a student's coursework for each graded assignment	Provide personalized, rich feedback (not just a grade) on assignments, projects, quizzes (beyond auto-graded). Written, audio, video comments; rubric feedback.		
Providing information or responding to questions about the content of a course or competency	Actively respond to student questions about course content (in forums, email, etc.). Monitor "Ask the Instructor" forums; respond within your promised timeframe.		
Facilitating a group discussion regarding the content of a course or competency	Lead or moderate discussion boards, pose probing questions, connect student ideas. Instructor replies, summaries, follow-ups, counterpoints in forums.		
Other instructional activities	Use interactive tools, guided case studies, group work with instructor oversight, or other institutional innovations. Instructor-led simulations, scaffolded peer review with instructor input, etc.		

Communication Methods	*Communication should be archivable. LMS communication is best practice.*		
News/Announcements			
Class Discussion Form			
Discussions			
Feedback			
Video/Audio Communication			
Synchronous Communication			
Email			
Other			
Score			
Advanced All Regular Interactions All Substantive Interactions All Communication Methods			
Essential 1 Regular Interactions 2 Substantive Interactions All Communication Methods			
Being Developed Anything below Essential			
Not Evident			

SECTION 6 NOTES

Section 7 – Learner Feedback

Instructor solicits learner feedback about the course at multiple points in the term.

Indicate if the required element is identified in the online course by marking:

NA = NOT APPLICABLE	X = NOT PRESENT	0 = NOT PRESENT IN ALL COURSES/DEVELOPING	1 = PRESENT/ACCOMPLISHED

ITEMS	EXAMPLE(S)	IDENTIFIED	NOTES
Early Check-In	Survey, Quiz, Discussion (link to contact privately), etc. that builds connections with students and helps to identify barriers early.		
Midterm feedback / survey	Ask students how the course is going; adjust interactions accordingly.		
End-of-course wrap-up	Address overall trends (common mistakes), hold a review session, send closure messages, final announcements, optional wrap session.		
Additional evaluation opportunities provided for students			
Verbal Confirmation: Instructor reviews learner feedback and adjust course elements in response to learner needs and feedback			

SECTION 7 NOTES

Section 8 – Content & Resources

Resources support learning objectives and are fully integrated into course components. Content is optimized for online delivery and targeted to support learning objectives.

Indicate if the required element is identified in the online course by marking:

NA = NOT APPLICABLE	X = NOT PRESENT	0 = NOT PRESENT IN ALL COURSES/DEVELOPING	1 = PRESENT/ACCOMPLISHED

ITEMS	EXAMPLE(S)	IDENTIFIED	NOTES
Verbal Confirmations that the following meet accessibility standards:			
External Tools & Resources	Publisher, Websites, etc.		
Course Design & Navigation	Course layout is logical, clear & consistent		
	Structured headings for screen reader navigation (can use LMS tool)		
	Don't use blinking text, animations, or auto-advancing slides that can't be paused		
	Flashing content can create barriers for students and in some cases, trigger seizures.		
Text & Visual Design	Readable Font (Arial, Verdana, 12pt.)		
	High contrast between text and background.		
	Color not used as the only indicator. (Ex: items in red are required, should be avoided).		
Images & Media	All images include meaningful alt text.		
	Decorative images marked as decorative.		
	Videos have accurate captions.		
	Audio files include transcripts.		
	Complex graphics (charts, maps, etc.) have text descriptions or data tables.		
Documents & Files	Uploaded files (PDF, Word, PPT) are accessible.		
	PDFs are accessible		
Links & Interactivity	Links have descriptive text (“View syllabus” instead of “Click here”).		
	Activities can be completed using only a keyboard. All interactive elements (quizzes, forms, discussions) are usable by keyboard only.		
LMS Accessibility	LMS developed course components are accessbile.		
Communication & Interaction	Students informed how to request accommodations.		
	Announcements and directions use clear, plain language.		
	Synchronous sessions include captions.		
	Synchronous sessions materials are provided in advance		
Testing & Evaluation	Extended time can be provided on quizzes/exams.		
	Question types are accessible (no drag-and-drop only).		

SECTION 8 NOTES

Section 9 – Grades & Attendance

Use of the College's LMS is required to document student participation, grades, course materials, etc., and is also required to be used in case of an emergency or College closures.

Indicate if the required element is identified in the online course by marking:

NA = NOT APPLICABLE	X = NOT PRESENT	0 = NOT PRESENT IN ALL COURSES/DEVELOPING	1 = PRESENT/ACCOMPLISHED

ITEMS	IDENTIFIED	NOTES
Participation is taken regularly		
Participation is visible to students		
Gradebook is complete and the methods of evaluation stated in the syllabus are present in the gradebook		
Gradebook is organized and includes all assessments.		
Gradebook is a current and accurate representation of learner progress		
Gradebook items are visible to students. (possible exceptions may occur)		
Overall/Current Grade is visible to students.		

SECTION 9 NOTES

Areas of Strength

AREAS OF STRENGTH NOTES

Opportunities for Improvement

OPPORTUNITES FOR IMPROVEMENT NOTES

Changes to be Made

CHANGES TO BE MADE NOTES